

List of Kanji

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漢字 1: Law (法)		
		
Law. Method.		
A religious (particularly Buddhist) meaning is also conveyed in some specialised compounds that include this 漢字.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	水 𠬞 + 去	
English	Water + Depart (??)	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Laws	of 「water」 「departure」.	
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ホウ (HŌ)	—
L.C.	ハッ、ホッ (HA-, HO-)	—
These readings always “double up” with the 音読み of the 漢字 that follow. The compounds in which they appear are obscure.		

漢字 2: Place (場)		
場		
A place.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	土 + (易 = 旦 + 勿)	
English	Earth/Soil + (Glorious/Bright = Daybreak/Dawn + Must not)	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
A place	on [earth] where [morning] animals [must not] be.	
A place	with [bright] [soil] feels glorious!	
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ジョウ (JŌ)	ば (ba)
Both readings are used extensively.		
Note the mix of 音読み and 訓読み in the second example below, a very common word.		
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations				
Law requires that ⟨HARBINGERS⟩ should ⟨HAUL⟩ the corpses to ⟨HOSPITAL⟩.				
+ Words and Compounds				
Kanji	English		Pronunciation	
方法	direction + law = <i>method; way</i>		ホウ・ホウ (HŌHŌ)	
文法	literature + law = <i>grammar</i>		ブン・ポウ (BUNPŌ)	
立法	stand + law = <i>legislation; law making</i>		リッ・ポウ (RIPPŌ)	
{...} Sample Sentence				
別	の	方法	を	考え出そう。
ベツ	の	ホウホウ	を	かんがえだそう
different	の	method	を	to think out
Let's think out another way.				

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Places	↳ bulging > with <JAW-DROPPING> experiences.	
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
工場	craft + place = <i>factory; plant</i>	コウ・ジョウ (KŌJŌ)
場所	place + location = <i>place; location</i>	ば・ショ (baSHO)
場合	place + match = <i>circumstances; situation</i>	ばあい (baai)
{...} Sample Sentence		
雨	の	場合 私 は 行かない。
あめ	の	ばあい わたし は いかない
rain	の	circumstance I は not go
In case it rains, I won't go.		

漢字 3: Course (科)

Course (of study), as well as other ideas related to *scholarly matters*.

This character is used to denote the *departments* and *faculties* of educational institutions, for example.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	禾 + 斗
English	Grain/Grain ear + Dipper (Volume Measure)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The **course** of nature is observed from [grain ears], [the Dipper], and [volume measures].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	カ (KA)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

A **course** on how to stop (CUSSING).

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
科学	course + study = <i>science</i>	カ・ガク (KA-GAKU)
科目	course + eye = <i>academic subject; course</i>	カ・モク (KA-MOKU)
教科書	teach + course + write = <i>textbook</i>	キョウ・カ・ショ (KYŌ-KASHO)

{...} Sample Sentence

数学	は	面白い	科目	です。
スウガク	は	おもしろい	カモク	です
maths	は	interesting	subject	be / is
<i>Mathematics is an interesting subject.</i>				

漢字 4: Younger Brother (弟)

Younger brother.

This 漢字 can also refer to the *disciples* or *pupils* of an accomplished master.

Ensure that you can easily see the difference between this character and 第 (“No.”, from Entry (??)).

∈ Composition

Glyphs	艹 + 冫 + ノ
English	Grass/Herb/Plant + Mourn (??) + Slash

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

My younger brother [mourned] about the [plants] being [slashed] to death.

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	おとうと (otōto)
L.C.	テイ、ダイ、デ (TEI, DAI, DE)	—

The last 2 音読み appear in only one word each, although the words themselves are commonly used. The first is 兄弟 (キョウ・ダイ/KYŌ-DAI) *brothers (as well as sisters)* from the 漢字 ‘elder brother’ and ‘younger brother’. This is the only compound, incidentally, in which 兄 is read with its less common onyomi of キョウ. The only word in which 弟 is read with デ is 弟子 (デ・シ/DESHI) *disciple; pupil*, from the 漢字 ‘younger brother’ and ‘child’.

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

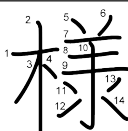
My younger brother (DECORATED) <a taut object> with (DYED) (TAPE).

+ Words and Compounds

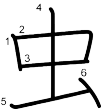
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
弟	<i>younger brother</i>	おとうと (otōto)

{...} Sample Sentence

彼	と	私	は	兄弟	です。
かれ	と	わたし	は	キョウ ダイ	です
he	と	I	は	brothers	be / is
<i>He and I are brothers.</i>					

漢字 5: Manner (様)		
様		
Manner. Way. When following a family name, this 漢字 acts as a very polite form of ‘Mr.’, ‘Mrs.’, or ‘Miss’.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	木 + 羊 + 水	
English	Tree + Sheep + Water	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
A manner	of giving [water] to your [trees] and [sheep].	

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ヨウ (YŌ)	さま (sama)
The kunyomi is the reading used to convey the polite form of ‘Mr.’, ‘Mrs.’, or ‘Miss’ mentioned above: 山本様 (やまもと・さま/yama-motosama) ‘Mr./Mrs./Miss Yamamoto’, for example.		
L.C.	—	—
♣♣ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Mannerisms of a <YAWNING> <Samaritan>.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
皆様	all + manner = <i>Ladies and Gentlemen!; all (of you)</i>	みなさま (minasama)
神様	God + manner = <i>God; god</i>	かみさま (kamisama)
様式	manner + type = <i>mode; form</i>	ヨウ・シキ (YŌSHIKI)

漢字 6: Insect (虫)		
		
Insect.		
Take note that the long vertical line is not combined into a single stroke with the horizontal line at the bottom when writing this 漢字; there are thus six strokes to the character here, not five.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	虫	
English	Insect	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#142).		

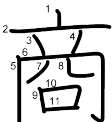
♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	チュウ (CHŪ)	むし (mushi)
L.C.	—	—
♣♣ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
The insect I <CHEWED> on became all <mushi>.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
虫	<i>insect; bug</i>	むし (mushi)
泣き虫	cry + insect = <i>crybaby</i>	なき むし (naki mushi)
成虫	become + insect = <i>adult insect</i>	セイ・チュウ (SEICHŪ)

漢字 7: Station (駅)		
駅		
Train station.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	馬 + 尺	
English	Horse + Measurement (??)	
	♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
The station	will take your [horse] [measurements].	

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	エキ (EKI)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations	
Station	an ⟨ECHINACEA⟩ greenhouse.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
駅	<i>train station</i>	エキ (EKI)
駅前	station + before = <i>in front of the station</i>	エキ・まえ (EKI-mae)
駅伝	station + transmit = <i>long-distance relay race</i>	エキ・デン (EKI-DEN)

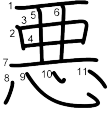
漢字 8: Commerce (商)		
商		
Commerce, Trade.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	立 + 冂 + 儿 + 口	
English	Stand/Erect + To enclose + Man/Person + Mouth	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ショウ (SHŌ)	—
L.C.	—	あきな (akina)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Commerce	is <akin> to a <SHORE>; it comes and goes.	

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
商人	commerce + person = <i>merchant; dealer</i>	ショウ・ニン (SHŌ-NIN)
商売	commerce + sell = <i>commerce; trade</i>	ショウ・バイ (SHŌ-BAI)
商店	commerce + shop = <i>shop; store</i>	ショウ・テン (SHŌ-TEN)

漢字 9: Bad (悪)

悪		
Bad, wrong, inferior...		
This 漢字 is bad news all around.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	亜 + 心
English	Asia (??) + Heart)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Bad [asian] [heart].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	アク (AKU)	わる (waru)
L.C.	オ (O)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Bad	<war> uniforms made <AKU> <OBJECT>.
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+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
悪い	<i>bad</i>	わるい (warui)
最悪	most + bad = <i>worst</i>	サイ・アク (SAIAKU)
悪意	bad + mind = <i>evil intention</i>	アク・イ (AKU-I)

漢字 10: Know (知)

知		
Know. Information.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	矢 + 口
English	Arrow + Mouth

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Know the [sounding] of an [arrow].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	チ (CHI)	し (shi)
L.C.	—	—

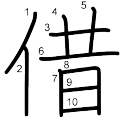
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Know	<CHEAP> <shifting> techniques.
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+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
知る	<i>know</i>	しる (shiru)
知らせ	<i>notice; information</i>	しらせ (shirase)
知人	know + person = <i>acquaintance</i>	チ・ジン (CHI-JIN)

漢字 11: Borrow (借)

借		
Borrow.		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	人 + 昔
English	Man/Person + Long Ago (??)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Borrowed	from a [person] [long ago].
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♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シャク (SHAKU)	か (ka)
L.C.	—	—

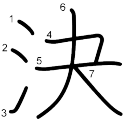
♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Borrowing	〈SHUCKS〉 is <customary>.
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+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
As you can see by the second example, this is another of those 漢字 whose verb form can incorporate its hiragana ending when forming nouns.		
借りる	<i>borrow</i>	かりる (kariru)
借手	borrow + hand = <i>borrower</i>	かりて (karite)
借金	borrow + gold (money) = <i>loan; a debt</i>	シャツキン (SHAK-KIN)

漢字 12: Decide (決)

決		
Decide.		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	水 + 大 + 讠
English	Water + Big/Large + Hangman/Gallow/YU

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Decide	between drowning in [water], or being [hanged] in front of a [large] crowd.
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♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ケツ (KETSU)	き (ki)
L.C.	—	—

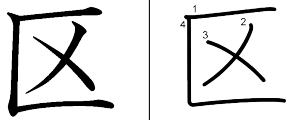
♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Decide	to <keep> the 〈KETS〉 alive.
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+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
決まる (intr.)	<i>to be decided / settled</i>	きまる (kimaru)
決める (tr.)	<i>to decide / settle</i>	きめる (kimeru)
決心	decide + heart = <i>determination; resolution</i>	ケツシン (KESSHIN)

漢字 13: Partition (区)



Partition, Division.

This character is used to indicate zones or areas. You will often see this 漢字 in mailing addresses, as it's used to denote a ward or district of a city; the final compound below, a famous area of Tokyo, offers an example.

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	匚 + ノ + 丶 + 丶
English	Square Box + NO/Slash + Dot
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Partition	between [strokes] and [dots].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ク (KU)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The division for <COOKING>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
区分	partition + part = <i>partition; division</i>	ク・ブン (KU-BUN)
区別	partition + different = <i>distinction; difference</i>	ク・ベツ (KU-BETSU)
新宿区	new + lodging + partition = <i>Shinjuku ward (in Tokyo)</i>	シン・ジュク・ク (SHIN-JUKU-KU)

漢字 14: Discharge (発)



Discharge. Break out.

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	𠂔 + 儿 + 二
English	Footsteps/Departure + Man/Person + Two
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Discharge	the [two] [people] making annoying [footstep] sounds.

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ハツ (HATSU)	—
L.C.	ホツ (HOTSU)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Break out of the <HUTS> to reach the <HOTSPOT>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
発音	discharge + sound = <i>pronunciation</i>	ハツ・オン (HATSU-ON)
出発	exit + discharge = <i>departure</i>	シュツ・パツ (SHUP-PATSU)
新発売	new + discharge + sell = <i>"Now on Sale"</i>	シン・バイ・ハツ (SHIN-BAI-HATSU)

漢字 15: How Many (幾)

幾	幾	
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How many, how much.

Another meaning is conveyed when this character precedes a ‘number’ 漢字 (as in the final example); in these cases the character means ‘some’ or ‘several’.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	戈 + 幺 + 人
English	Spear/Halberd + Short Thread + Person/Man

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
How many [short] [people] are you going to kill with that [spear].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	いく (iku)
L.C.	キ (KI)	—

You are likely to meet this reading in one compound: 幾何学 (キ・カ・ガク/KIKAGAKU) ‘*geometry*’, from the 漢字 ‘how many’, ‘what’, and ‘study’.

♣♣ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

How many <KILLINGS> are you going to <eke out>?

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
幾つ	<i>how much; how many</i>	いく・つ (ikutsu)
幾ら	<i>how much</i>	いく・ら (iku-ra)
幾百	<i>how much + hundred = some / several hundreds</i>	いく・ヒャク (iku-HYAKU)

漢字 16: Room (室)

室	室	
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Room, Chamber.

As they’re very similar, make sure not to confuse this character with 屋, the 漢字 for ‘roof’ we learned back in Entry 281.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	宀 + 至
English	Roof + Reach (??)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
In the room I [reached] for the [roof].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シツ (SHITSU)	—
L.C.	—	むろ (muro)

♣♣ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

In the room we uncovered <muron> under the (SHEETS).
--

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
室内	room + inside = <i>indoor(s)</i>	シツ・ナイ (SHITSU-NAI)
室外	room + outside = <i>outdoor(s)</i>	シツ・ガイ (SHITSU-GAI)
温室	warm + room = <i>hothouse; greenhouse</i>	オン・シツ (ONSHITSU)

漢字 17: Fall (落)

落		
Fall. Fail.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	艹 + 夂 + 水 氷 + 口
English	Grass/Herb/Plant + Winter + Water + Mouth

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ラク (RAKU)	お (o)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
Falling was luckily an obligation.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
The verbs in the first and second examples below can sometimes absorb their hiragana endings when forming words with other 漢字.		
落ちる (intr.)	<i>to fall</i>	おちる (ochiru)
落とす (tr.)	<i>to let fall/drop</i>	おとす (otosu)
急落	hasten + fall = <i>sudden drop/decline</i>	キュウ・ラク (KYŪ-RAKU)

漢字 18: Fast (速)

速		
Fast, in terms of speed and movement. Recall that 早 (“early”, Entry ??) is more concerned with the idea of “fast” in terms of time.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	束 + 辶
English	Bundle (??) + Road/Walk

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Fast [bundles] of feet on the [road].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ソク (SOKU)	はや (haya)
L.C.	—	すみ (sumi)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
The fast <SOCK> and <hay allergy> is what they are <sueing me> for.

+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
速い	<i>fast</i>	はやい (hayai)
高速	tall + fast = <i>high-speed</i>	コウ・ソク (KŌ-SOKU)
速度	fast + degree = <i>speed</i>	ソク・ド (SOKU-DO)

漢字 19: Colour (色)

Color.

Interestingly, this 漢字 also conveys a decidedly erotic meaning to many compounds in which it appears (as it does in the second example below).

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	色
English	Color

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Part of the 漢字 radicals (#139).

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シヨク (SHOKU)	いろ (iro)
Both of these readings are used frequently in compounds, although いろ is more common in the first position, and シヨク more common in the second and third.		
L.C.	シキ (SHIKI)	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The colour of the <iroko> tree (SHOCKED) the (SHEIKH).

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
色	color	いろ (iro)
色目	color + eye = <i>amorous glance</i>	いろめ (irome)
原色	original + color = <i>primary color</i>	ゲン・シヨク (GENSHOKU)

漢字 20: Start (始)

Start.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	女 + 台
English	Woman + Platform (??)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Start a [platform] for [women].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シ (SHI)	はじ (haji)
L.C.	—	—

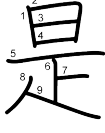
♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Start the <haji> to (SHIELD) you from evil forces.

+ Words and Compounds

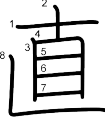
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
始まる (intr.)	to start	はじまる (hajimaru)
始める (tr.)	to start (something)	はじめる (hajimeru)
原始	original + start = <i>primitive</i>	ゲン・シ (GENSHI)

漢字 21: Approve (是)

		
Approve. To be right.		
∈ Composition Glyphs 日 + 疋 English Sun/Day + Roll/Bolt of Cloth		
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components Approve [today] whether the [roll] of scripture is in order.		

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ゼ (ZE)	—
L.C.	—	—
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Approve of <ZEALOUS> works.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
是非	approve + un- = <i>by any means; without fail</i>	ゼ・ヒ (ZEHI)

漢字 22: Straight (直)

		
Straight, direct, at once.		
By extension comes the idea of things being correct or corrected (best illustrated by the transitive/intransitive verb pair below). An important aspect of these two verbs can be seen when they attach to the end of other 漢字 as a suffix (as in the third example). In such cases, this character gives the compound a sense of ‘redoing’ whatever the first 漢字 represents. Ensure that you can clearly see the difference between this 漢字 and 真 (‘true’, from Entry ??).		
∈ Composition Glyphs 一 + 丨 + 目 + 十 English One + Pole + Eye + Ten		
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components The straight [pole] [impaled] [one] [eye] of the [scarecrow].		

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	チョク (CHOKU)	なお (nao)
L.C.	ジキ (JIKI)	ただ (tada)
You will encounter the kunyomi in only one word: 直ちに (ただちに/tadachi ni) ‘immediately, at once’		
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
The straight <CHALK> from <TAJIKISTAN> was used by <Naomi> to write <tadah!>		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
直る (intr.)	<i>to be corrected / repaired</i>	なおる (naoru)
治す (tr.)	<i>to correct / repair / fix</i>	なおす (naosu)
書き直す	write + straight = <i>rewrite; write again</i>	かき なおす (kaki naosu)
直線	straight + line = <i>straight line</i>	チョク・セン (CHOKUSEN)

漢字 23: Illness (病)

病	病	
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Illness. Disease.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	疒 + 丙
English	Sickness + Third (??)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Illness, [sickness], and disease are [three] words meaning the same thing.

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ビョウ (BYŌ)	—
L.C.	ヘイ (HEI)	や、やまい (ya, yamai)

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Illness makes <ya mind> go (HAYWIRE) even when you're <young>. Sooner or later it will be yours.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
Note the final compound below uses the less common onyomi for 持.		
病気	illness + spirit = <i>illness</i>	ビョウ・キ (BYŌ-KI)
病院	illness + institution = <i>hospital</i>	ビョウ・イン (BYŌ-IN)
持病	hold + illness = <i>chronic disease</i>	ジ・ビョウ (JIBYŌ)

漢字 24: Together (共)

共	共	
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Together.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	二 + 丨 + 八
English	Two + Pole + Eight

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Together, [two] is better than [one], to [part], to divide, and to conquer.

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	キョウ (KYŌ)	とも (tomo)
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Together in (KYOTO) <tomorrow>.

+ Words and Compounds

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
共	<i>together</i>	とも (tomo)
共同	together + same = <i>cooperation; collaboration</i>	キョウ・ドウ (KYŌ-DŌ)
共和国	together + harmony + country = <i>republic</i>	キョウ・ワ・コク (KYŌ-WA-KOKU)

漢字 25: Desire (願)		
願	願	
Desire, petition. This character carries a light tone of entreaty.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	原 + 頁	
English	Original (??) + Big shell	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
I desire the [original] [big shells].		

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ガン (GAN)	ねが (nega)
L.C.	—	—
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Desire to <negate> the <GUNS>.		
+ Words and Compounds		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
願う	<i>desire; request politely</i>	ねがう (nega-u)
お願いします	<i>please</i>	お ねがい します (o negai shimasu)
願書	<i>desire + write = written application / request</i>	ガン・ショ (GAN-SHO)